

Oxygen regulator
Each crew member had an oxygen hose at his position. If he needed to move around in the aircraft, he grabbed a walk-around oxygen bottle.





Sight and ammunition
The waist guns had sophisticated sights to aid the gunner. In theory, a gunner could use up an ammunition belt in half a minute, although in practice he naturally fired much shorter bursts.



M4 flak helmet
Made of steel covered with green cloth, this was issued in late 1943. It was designed to be worn with headphones and had been slimmed down so it could be worn by gunners in their turrets.

Oxygen bottles
Some 18 bottles of oxygen were carried on board the aircraft. They were essential supplies since operational flights were made at altitudes over 7,600m (25,000ft).

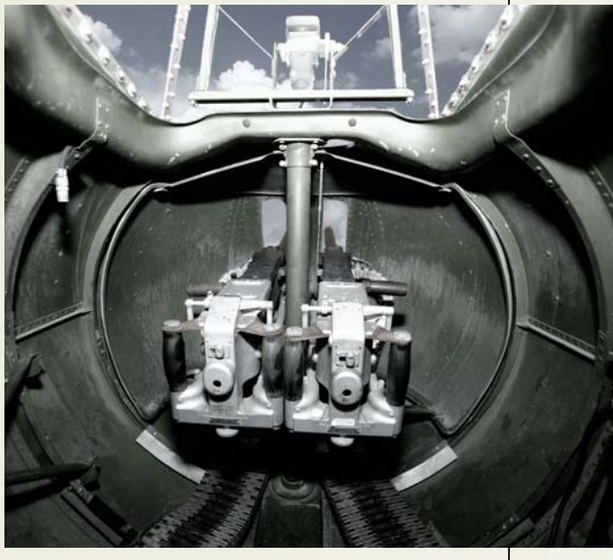


Waist gun
The waist gunners, between the radio operator's position and the tail gun, fired out of each side of the aircraft, exposed to the freezing air. Spent shell cases covered the floor of the aircraft once the gun was in use.

Tail turret
The rear gunner knelt in his position on padded knee-holds. Since attack from behind was the obvious tactic for fighter aircraft, these hydraulically-controlled twin guns were crucial to the bomber's defence.

Flight deck
The pilot and co-pilot sat on each side of the control yokes, the pilot on the left-hand side, and the co-pilot on the right. The cockpit afforded excellent visibility.







Elevator wires
Control cables ran along the ceiling from the cockpit to the tail and wings of the aircraft to manipulate the rudder and wing flaps.



Fuselage interior
This is the view forward along the fuselage towards the radio operator's position, and, beyond that, the bomb bay. The aluminium rings of which the fuselage structure was made are visible. The black column supports the ball turret beneath the fuselage.